Unit Outline

ISYS6020 (V.1) Artificial Intelligence in Business: Strategy and Management
Semester 1, 2026

Unit study package number:	ISYS6020
Mode of study:	Internal
Tuition pattern summary:	Note: For any specific variations to this tuition pattern and for precise information refer to the Learning Activities section. Lecture: 1 x 1 Hours Weekly Computer Laboratory: 1 x 2 Hours Weekly This unit does not have a fieldwork component.
Credit value:	25
Pre-requisite units:	Nil
Co-requisite units:	Nil
Anti-requisite units:	Nil
Result type:	Grade/Mark
Approved incidental fees:	Information about approved incidental fees can be obtained from our website. Visit https://www.curtin.edu.au/students/essentials/fees/understanding-your-fees for details.
Unit coordinator:	**Name:** Dr Michael Borck **Phone:** +61 8 9266 3976 **Email:** Michael.Borck@curtin.edu.au **Location** Building: 402 - Room: 720 **Consult:**
Teaching Staff:	
Administrative contact:	**Name:** FBL Teaching Support **Phone:** Please email **Email or Website:** FBL-TSUnitAdmin@curtin.edu.au **Location** Building: N/A - Room: N/A
Learning Management System:	Blackboard

Acknowledgement of Country

Curtin University acknowledges Aboriginal and Torres Strait Islander people, the First Peoples of this place we call Australia, and recognise them for caring for Country for more than 60,000 years. We are honoured and grateful for the privilege to maintain campuses operating in Boorloo (Perth) and Karlkurla (Kalgoorlie) in Australia. We pay our respects to Elders past and present as Custodians and Owners of these lands. We recognise their deep knowledge and their cultural, spiritual and educational practices, and aspire to learn and teach in partnership with them. Curtin also acknowledges First Nations peoples connected with our global campuses. We are committed to working in partnership with all Custodians and Owners to strengthen and embed First Nations' voices and perspectives in our decision-making, now and into the future.

Syllabus

Contemporary organisations are realising that artificial intelligence has the potential to radically transform the business environment. This unit examines the building blocks required to evaluate opportunities and plan implementation alongside ongoing management and governance of artificial intelligence initiatives. Areas of focus include development of enterprise AI strategies and the organisational and technical infrastructure required to support AI applications.

Introduction

This unit develops the strategic and managerial capabilities required to lead AI transformation in organizations. Rather than focusing on technical implementation, students adopt an executive perspective to address fundamental questions: Why should an organization invest in AI? Which opportunities should be prioritized? How should AI initiatives be governed and scaled?

Through a semester-long case study (Cloudcore Networks), students progress from assessing organizational AI readiness through to designing governance frameworks and scaling strategies. The unit combines individual strategic analysis with collaborative project work, preparing graduates to bridge the gap between technical AI capabilities and business value creation.

Unit Learning Outcomes

Curtin University's six Graduate Capabilities indicate to employers that graduates possess discipline knowledge and valuable skills. Each course unit addresses these capabilities through specific learning outcomes, which outline what students need to know and do to succeed. Assessments are designed to test these outcomes, ensuring that upon completion, students have met all learning objectives.

Your course has been designed so that on graduating you will have achieved all of Curtin's Graduate Capabilities through the assurance of the learning process in each unit.

	On successful completion of this unit student can:	Graduate Capabilities addressed
1	Critically and ethically analyse opportunities for implementation of AI applications in organisations	
2	Evaluate and plan implementation of AI applications in response to identified opportunities	

	On successful completion of this unit student can:	Graduate Capabilities addressed
3	Design and build a simple AI application prototype	
4	Develop management and governance frameworks for organisations implementing AI applications	
5	Evaluate and effectively communicate the benefits and risks associated with organisational use of AI	

Curtin's Graduate Capabilities

	GC1: Apply knowledge, skills and capabilities		**GC2: Innovative, creative and / or entrepreneurial**		**GC3: Effective communicators with digital competence**
	GC4: Globally engaged and responsive		**GC5: Culturally competent to engage respectfully with local First Peoples and other diverse cultures**		**GC6: Industry-connected and career-capable**
Find out more about Curtin's Graduate Capabilities.					

Learning Activities

This unit combines weekly lectures with hands-on lab workshops where students apply strategic AI concepts to realistic business scenarios.

Lectures (1 hour weekly)

- Introduction to strategic frameworks and key concepts
- Industry examples and current AI trends
- Preparation for lab activities

Lab Sessions (2 hours weekly)

- Facilitated workshops applying frameworks to the Cloudcore Networks case study
- Activities build progressively toward assessment deliverables
- Peer discussion and collaborative problem-solving

Independent Study

- Textbook readings from required texts (AIM and AAI)
- Individual research and analysis for Assessment 1 (Weeks 1-6)
- Team collaboration for Assessment 2 (Weeks 9-14)

Learning Resources

The text(s) for this unit are:

Upadhyay, M. A. (2021). Artificial Intelligence for Managers: Leverage the Power of AI to Transform Organizations and Reshape Your Career. BPB Publications. (Abbreviated as AIM)

Electronic: No **Essential:** Yes **Resource Type:** Book **ISBN:** 978-9389898385

Yao, M., & Koidan, K. (2024). Applied Artificial Intelligence: A Handbook for Business Leaders (2nd ed.). TOPBOTS Inc. (Abbreviated as AAI)

Electronic: No **Essential:** Yes **Resource Type:** Book **ISBN:** 978-0998289021

Assessment

Assessment policy exemptions

There are no exemptions to the assessment policy

Assessment Schedule

	Task	Value %	Date Due	Unit Learning Outcome(s) Assessed	Late Assessments Accepted?	Assessment Extensions Considered? *
1	AI Implementation Proposal	40 %	**Week:**6 **Day:**Friday 27 March 2026 **Time:**23:59	1,2	Yes	Yes
2	Group Report and Prototype AI Application	60 %	**Week:**11,13, Exam Period **Day:**Friday **Time:**23:59	3,4,5	Yes	Yes

*Please refer to the Late Assessment and the Assessment Extension sections below for specific details and conditions.

Detailed Information on assessment tasks

AI Implementation Proposal

Task: Develop a strategic AI implementation proposal for a chosen organization (real or Cloudcore Networks), demonstrating human-in-the-loop AI collaboration.

Component	Weight	Description
Part A: AI Conversation Log	10%	Document AI collaboration process with critical evaluation
Part B: Annotated Strategic Report	20%	2,000-word report with maturity assessment, strategy, governance
Part C: Infrastructure & Governance Roadmap	10%	Visual summary of infrastructure and risk mitigation

Marking Criteria: AI maturity assessment depth; strategic alignment; implementation feasibility; evidence of critical human-in-the-loop evaluation; professional presentation.

Submission: Single PDF via Blackboard Turnitin

Group Report and Prototype AI Application

Task: Develop an AI Proof of Concept prototype and governance framework through three progressive milestones.

Milestone	Weight	Due	Deliverable
2a: Prototype Specification	10%	Week 11	Tool justification, logic spec, user flows, risks
2b: Governance Framework	10%	Week 13	Accountability structure, decision rights, risk register
2c: Final Group Report	40%	Exam Period	Integrated documentation, demo, scaling strategy

Marking Criteria: Platform appropriateness; documentation clarity; governance comprehensiveness; alignment with industry frameworks; prototype functionality; team collaboration evidence.

Submission: PDF via Blackboard for each milestone. Peer evaluation forms submitted individually with 2c

Pass requirements

To pass this unit, students must:

- **Achieve an overall mark of 50% or higher** across all assessments
- **Submit all assessment components** by their respective due dates (or approved extensions)
- **Demonstrate individual contribution** to group work through peer evaluation and documented participation

Assessment Moderation

Fair assessment through moderation

Moderation describes a quality assurance process to ensure that assessments are appropriate to the learning outcomes, and that student work is evaluated consistently by assessors. Minimum standards for the moderation of assessments are described in the Assessment and Student Progression Manual.

Pre-marking moderation

- **Clear criteria**: Explicit rubrics provided for all assessments
- **Standardisation**: Marking guides and pre-marking calibration between assessors
- **Blind marking**: Used where applicable to reduce bias

Intra-marking / Post-marking moderation

- **Sampling:** UC reviews a sample of marked work across assessors
- **Borderline review:** Second marker reviews grades near pass/fail or grade boundaries
- **Feedback loop:** Assessment tasks refined based on marking experience
- **Appeals:** Students may seek clarification or challenge grades through the formal appea

Late Assessment

Where the submission of a late assessment is permitted, late penalties will be consistently applied in this unit.

Where a late assessment **is** permitted for an assessment item or the entirety of the unit (refer to the Assessment Schedule table in this Unit Outline) and the student does not have an approved assessment extension:

1. For assessment items submitted within the first 24 hours after the due date/time, students will be penalised by a deduction of 5% of the total marks allocated for the assessment task;
2. For each additional 24 hour period commenced an additional penalty of 10% of the total marks allocated for the assessment item will be deducted; and
3. Assessment items submitted more than 168 hours late (7 calendar days) will receive a mark of zero.

Where late assessment **is NOT** permitted for an assessment item or the entirety of the unit (refer to the Assessment Schedule table in this Unit Outline) and the student does not have an approved assessment extension:

1. All assessment items submitted after the due date/time will receive a mark of zero.

Assessment Extension

Where an application for an assessment extension **is** permitted for an assessment item(s) within this unit (refer to the Assessment Schedule table in this Unit Outline):

1. A student who is unable to complete an assessment item by/on the due date/time as a result of exceptional circumstances beyond the student's control, may apply for an assessment extension on the Assessment Extension Form and within the student OASIS (My Studies tab – Study Essentials) account.
2. Submit the application for an Assessment Extension with supporting documentation via the online form.
3. An application may be accepted up to five working days after the due date/time of the assessment item where the student is able to provide a verifiable explanation as to why they were not able to submit the application prior to the assessment due date/time.

Where an application for an assessment extension **is NOT** permitted for an assessment item(s) within this unit (refer to the Assessment Schedule table in this Unit Outline):

1. All assessment items submitted after the due date/time will be subject to late penalties or receive a mark of zero depending on the unit permitting late assessment submissions.

Deferred Assessments

If your results show that you have been granted a deferred assessment you should immediately check OASIS for details.

Deferred examinations/tests will be held from 13/07/2026 to 18/07/2026. Notification to students will be made after the Board of Examiners' meeting via the Official Communications Channel (OCC) in OASIS.

Further Assessments

Further assessments, if granted by the Board of Examiners, will be held between 13/07/2026 to 18/07/2026. Notification to eligible students granted a further assessment will be made after the Board of Examiners meeting via the Official Communications Channel in OASIS.

It is the responsibility of the student to be available to complete the requirements of a further assessment. If your results show that you have been granted a further assessment you should immediately check OASIS for details.

Reasonable adjustments for students with disabilities/health circumstances likely to impact on studies

A Curtin Access Plan (CAP) is a document that outlines the type and level of support required by a student with a disability or health condition to have equitable access to their studies at Curtin. Carers for people with disability may also be eligible for support. This support can include alternative exam or test arrangements, study materials in accessible formats, access to Curtin's facilities and services or other support as discussed with an advisor from AccessAbility Services.

Documentation is required from your treating Health Professional to confirm your health circumstances or carer responsibilities.

If you think you may be eligible for a CAP, please contact AccessAbility Services. If you already have a CAP, please provide it to the Unit Coordinator in week 1 of each study period.

Referencing style

The referencing style of this unit is Chicago 18th Author-Date.

More information can be found on this style from the library web site
https://uniskills.library.curtin.edu.au/referencing/chicago18/introduction/

Privacy

Curtin's privacy statement describes how personal information is handled. Curtin may record or transmit your image or voice during learning activities or class participation, both on campus and internationally. Students may also record for study purposes but must not share these recordings publicly and must seek permission from those recorded. Recordings cannot be used for commercial purposes or shared beyond personal study. Breaching the privacy policy or procedures may lead to disciplinary action under Statute No 10. For privacy concerns, please contact your Unit Coordinator.

Copyright

The course material for this unit is provided solely for your personal research and study. It is protected by copyright and sharing it on third-party websites without Curtin University's written consent is a copyright infringement.

Academic Integrity

Curtin's Student Charter, Academic Integrity Program (AIP), and core Values guide expectations regarding student behaviour and responsibilities. Information on these topics can be found on the Academic Integrity Website.

Appropriate Use of Generative Artificial Intelligence (Gen-AI) technologies

Curtin supports the philosophy of teaching students to appropriately use Gen-AI technologies in an ethical and responsible way. Gen-AI technology is rapidly evolving and being incorporated into software programs, so it is important to understand how it can and cannot be used within your studies.

Check your assessment instructions carefully before using any Gen-AI software (e.g. Chat GPT, Midjourney, GitHub Copilot, etc.). You are not permitted to use Gen-AI software in any assessment task unless written permission is explicitly granted by the Unit Coordinator (e.g. within Blackboard or the assignment specifications). Where use of Gen-AI is approved, you must use it in accordance with those instructions. Unapproved, inappropriate, or undisclosed use may be dishonest or unfair behaviour, and thus considered misconduct.

Visit the appropriate use of Gen-AI technologies website and library website on Gen-AI for more information.

Academic Integrity Warnings

An Academic Integrity Warning may be issued to a student in limited circumstances and only where misconduct is not involved.

Academic Misconduct

Staff members are required to report suspected misconduct. Academic misconduct means conduct by a student that is dishonest or unfair in connection with any academic work. This includes all types of plagiarism, cheating, collusion, falsification or fabrication of content, and behaviours like falsifying medical certificates for extension. Contract cheating, the use of file sharing, translation services/apps, paraphrasing tools (text-spinners), article generators, unapproved and inappropriate use of Gen-AI tools, and assignment help websites also may be considered academic misconduct. The longer term personal, social, and financial consequences of misconduct can be severe, so please ask your tutors or unit coordinator if you need clarification or are unsure what to do.

Information and Communications Technology (ICT) Expectations

Curtin students need a reliable internet connection to access OASIS email, the Learning Management System, and Library Services. A computer or mobile device is also required for preparing and submitting assessments.

You may be required to use Respondus Monitor with Lockdown Browser to verify your identity and monitor your behaviour during online tests and exams. This software requires a computer with a webcam, a microphone, and a stable internet connection. It is not compatible with tablets or iPads at Curtin.

For general ICT assistance, visit the system help and guides website. For study resources and assistance, check out the UniSkills website.

Additional information

Enrolment

It is your responsibility to ensure that your enrolment is correct - you can check your enrolment through the eStudent option on OASIS, where you can also print an Enrolment Advice.

Student Rights and Responsibilities

Students must be aware of all relevant legislation, policies, and procedures concerning their rights and responsibilities. This information is available on the student rights and responsibilities website.

Student Equity

Several factors might hinder students from performing their best in studies or assessments, such as disabilities, medical conditions, significant caring responsibilities, pregnancy, religious practices, remote living, or other reasons. If you believe you are unfairly disadvantaged, contact the appropriate service. University staff can only assist if they are aware of your circumstances, so please reach out for help.

To discuss your needs in relation to:

1. Disability or medical conditions, contact AccessAbility Services
2. Elite athletes, contact Elite Athlete Coordinator
3. All other grounds, contact the Student Wellbeing Advisory Service

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Recent Unit Changes & Response to Student Feedback

Students are encouraged to provide feedback through student surveys (such as Insight and the annual Student Experience Survey) and interactions with teaching staff.

Listed below are some recent changes to the unit as a result of student feedback.

This is a new unit offering for Semester 1, 2026.

Design Philosophy

This unit has been designed with contemporary AI developments in mind, integrating hands-on experience with AI tools as a core learning activity rather than a supplementary resource. The assessment structure emphasizes practical application through the Cloudcore Networks case study, allowing students to develop strategic AI implementation skills in a realistic business context.

Key Features Based on Best Practice:

- **Integrated AI collaboration**: Assessment 1 requires documented AI conversation logs, preparing students for AI-augmented professional practice
- **Progressive team project**: Assessment 2 uses staged milestones to support iterative development and timely feedback
- **Dragon's Den presentations**: Peer evaluation develops critical analysis skills alongside presentation competence
- **Tuition-free weeks**: Weeks 7-8 provide dedicated time for team planning and initial collaboration

Student feedback will be actively sought throughout the semester to inform continuous improvement.

Program Calendar

Week	Begin Date	Topic	Content	Before the Lab	Readings	Assessment Due
0	9 Feb	Orientation	Unit introduction, LMS setup, case study overview	Review unit outline, LMS access	—	—
1	16 Feb	AI Transformation Landscape	Three Horizons, Six Building Blocks, AI maturity	AI Landscape concepts, Cloudcore introduction	AIM Ch 1; AAI Ch 1–2	—
2	23 Feb	Opportunity Identification & Ethics	Value-Risk Framework, Ethical Opportunity Matrix	Ethical frameworks overview	AAI Ch 4	—
3	2 Mar	Planning & Strategy	AI Transformation Matrix, Implementation Roadmap	Implementation planning frameworks	AIM Ch 3	—
4	9 Mar	Infrastructure	Data Value Pyramid, Build vs Buy decisions	Infrastructure decision frameworks	AIM Ch 4	—
5	16 Mar	Management & ROI	AI Investment Model, Cost-Benefit Analysis	ROI frameworks, business case development	AIM Ch 5	—
6	23 Mar	The Proposal	Assessment finalization, peer review, **team formation**	Compile all materials from Weeks 1–5	—	**Assessment 1** (Fri)

7	30 Mar	Prototype Design	Strategic PoC concepts, no-code platforms, user flows	PoC design principles, platform options	—	—
8	6 Apr	*Tuition Free Period*	*No scheduled classes — Teams begin project planning*	Review Assessment 2 brief, meet with team	—	—
9	13 Apr	*Tuition Free Period*	*No scheduled classes — Teams continue planning*	Team planning, initial prototype ideas	—	—
10	20 Apr	PoC Build	PoC specification finalization, tool justification	Complete PoC documentation	—	—
11	27 Apr	Governance	DDCD Crisis Response, accountability layers, NIST/EU AI Act	Governance frameworks overview	AIM Ch 7	**Milestone 2a** (Fri)
12	4 May	Framework Review	Risk audits, governance finalization, residual risks	Complete governance documentation	—	—
13	11 May	Scaling AI	Scaling strategies, organizational barriers, change management	Scaling frameworks, case studies	AAI Ch 8	**Milestone 2b** (Fri)

14	18 May	Strategic Defense	Team presentations (Dragon’s Den format), peer feedback	Prepare presentation, review rubric	—	—
15	25 May	*Study Week*	—	—	—	—
16/17	1-12 Jun	*Examination Period*	*Final group report submission*	—	—	**Milestone 2c**